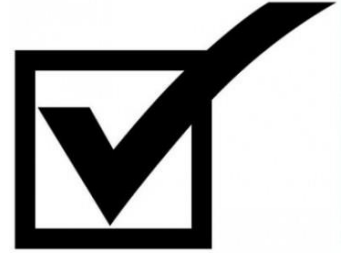




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

NATIONAL 2023
PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

NATIONAL PRELIMINARY SCENARIO KEY:

Marie is the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) at Digital Solutions, a non-profit company. The company just received a large federal grant to set up a new location. The company needs to purchase furniture and other accessories for the new location. Marie's best friend owns an office furniture store and scheduled a dinner meeting to discuss the project. Although her friend's quote was nearly twice the closest bid, Marie agreed to purchase everything from her. To "sweeten the pot," her friend is going to give Marie a brand-new entertainment center for her home

- What are the possible consequences of Marie's actions?
- Could this be considered unethical and a conflict of interest?
- Does this decision violate any laws or regulations?
- What procedures should be implemented to reduce similar purchasing situations in the future?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Page 3 - Open communication is conducting professional business with transparency and dual freedom to exchange information.
- Page 3- Equal opportunities is ensuring those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty, and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Page 3 - Digital Solutions' employees agree to uphold the following standards:
 - take responsibility for my actions, decisions, and obligations
 - make honest and transparent decisions which are good for all involved
 - present information in a clear and timely manner to all parties
 - encourage actions, policies, and procedures which promote high standards for conduct and professionalism
 - uphold and respect the laws that govern my work

- Page 4 – Personal values versus company profits are often a source of conflict as are dilemmas triggered by breaches of confidentiality, personal bias, or illegal activity.
- Page 5 – Companies that are involved in scandals or known for unsavory business practices are viewed by the public with much skepticism.
- Page 5 – Personal ethics: a person's ethics in their personal life will undoubtedly affect how they conduct business.
- Page 5 – Business ethics: Prevent exploitation, harassment, and intimidation in the workplace. It ensures that the organization abides by the law of the land. It is difficult to remain innocent if you make a habit of deceiving and exploiting people.
- Page 5 – Fairness: How fairly you treat others in negotiations or contractually will ultimately affect who is willing to deal with you in the future.
- Page 5 – Integrity is the foundation on which good commerce is built and involves holding to your principles even when it would be easier or more profitable to compromise them.
- Page 5 – Trustworthiness: neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness.
- Page 5 – Internal + External: good business practice requires that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside the business.
- Page 5 – Leadership: If the leaders of an organization practice good business ethics, chances are better that employees will follow the example.
- Page 5 – Values: a person's moral code is integrated into his/her business ethics. A person uses his/her own personal values in the context of his/her business dealings.
- Page 6 – Paying respect to co-workers, oneself, and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional. Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.
- Page 6 – Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby opening greater lines of communication and potentially increased trust.
- Page 7 – Effective communication skills will give you an advantage over most of your colleagues. Knowing how to efficiently communicate your message will enable you to increase the amount of influence that you will have in dealing with your peers, supervisors, and subordinates.
- Page 9 – Confidentiality is critical in many professional engagements and is key to organizational risk management and both personal and professional liability.